

Name: _____

Date: _____

The Fete Day Friend

Year 4 reading comprehension · Story · 13 marks · About 20 minutes

The school fete was the biggest day of the year. By ten o'clock the oval was crowded with stalls, balloons and the smell of sizzling sausages. Lachlan stood behind the lamington stall in a bright green apron, counting trays of chocolate and coconut squares.

At the edge of the oval, a girl with a long plait stood by herself. It was Aroha, who had started at the school only last week. She held a paper cup in both hands and watched the other children laugh and run. She did not walk over to anyone.

Lachlan noticed. He remembered his own first day at the school, when he had spent the whole of lunch pretending to read a book he already knew by heart. "Hey!" he called. "Aroha! Can you count change? I'm hopeless at it."

Aroha's head jerked up. For a moment she looked around, as if he might be talking to somebody else. Then she crossed the oval slowly and stopped at the edge of the stall. "I'm good at maths," she said quietly.

"Perfect," said Lachlan, and he handed her the cash tin. Soon a line of customers stretched all the way to the sausage sizzle. Aroha counted coins quickly and carefully, and every time she gave the right change, her shoulders loosened a little more.

By lunchtime, the trays were empty. Aroha was laughing at one of Lachlan's terrible jokes when a girl from her class called, "Aroha! Come and do the egg-and-spoon race!" She looked at Lachlan. "Go on," he grinned. "I'll manage the till." As she ran off, she called back over her shoulder, "Save me the last lamington!"

1. What was Lachlan selling at the fete? (1 mark)

2. How do you think Aroha was feeling at the start? What details in the story make you think so? (2 marks)

3. Why do you think Lachlan asked Aroha to help with the change? (2 marks)

4. What does the word “hopeless” mean in “I’m hopeless at it”? (1 mark)

5. Was Lachlan really hopeless at counting change? Explain your answer. (2 marks)

6. The story says that “her shoulders loosened a little more.” What does this show about how Aroha felt? (2 marks)

7. What do you think will happen between Aroha and Lachlan after the fete? Use a clue from the story to explain your idea. (2 marks)

8. Choose the statement that best sums up the story. Write its letter. (1 mark)

- A. A small act of kindness can help someone feel they belong.
- B. Lamingtons are the most popular food at the school fete, so every stall sells them.
- C. Egg-and-spoon races are the best part of the day, and everybody should enter one.
- D. Counting change is much harder than playing games, so students should avoid it.

Answer: _____

Writing task: Write about a time someone helped you feel welcome, or a time you helped someone else.
